Northbridge University Office of Research: Research Data and Generative AI Guidance (SYNTHETIC TEST DOCUMENT)

SYNTHETIC TEST DOCUMENT. Northbridge University is fictional. This document exists only to test a retrieval system.

Guidance number: OR-GUID-27. Effective date: September 1, 2026. Scope: all faculty, staff and researchers, university-wide. Owner: Office of Research.

1. Purpose. This guidance protects research integrity and sponsor obligations when researchers use generative AI.

2. Rule for research data. Research data classified above Level 1 (Public) must not be entered into any generative AI tool, including university-licensed tools.

3. Reason. Sponsor agreements and data use agreements often restrict where data may be processed. Generative AI services may log prompts outside the systems those agreements cover.

4. Allowed uses. Researchers may use generative AI for drafting text that contains no research data, for code that contains no research data, and with Level 1 (Public) data.

5. Questions. Contact the Office of Research Compliance.